

School CRM — Custom Build Proposal

Built on the ARI Platform

Prepared for: [School Name]

Prepared by: [Your Name / Company]

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Status: Draft for Discussion

1. Executive Summary

[School Name] needs a centralized system to manage **family inquiries, admissions follow-up, communication, and enrollment pipeline** — without juggling spreadsheets, email threads, and disconnected tools.

We recommend a **custom school CRM** built on our existing **ARI platform** (proven CRM + communications engine), configured for education instead of real estate.

This approach delivers:

- Lower cost than enterprise school suites (often **\$1,000+/month**)
- Features tailored to this school's workflow
- Dedicated account management with technical support behind the scenes
- Room to grow (parent portal, forms, integrations) in later phases

Build vs. Buy:

- **Buy existing** if they need full school ERP (grades, attendance, billing, cafeteria, etc.)
- **Custom build (recommended)** if primary need is admissions CRM + parent communication + staff workflow

2. Scope of Work — Phase 1 (Recommended)

Included in Phase 1

A. Core CRM (School-Configured)

- Family & contact records (parents/guardians, students, inquiry source)
- Custom pipeline: Inquiry → Contacted → Tour Scheduled → Applied → Accepted → Enrolled → Lost
- Notes, tags, and activity history per family
- Staff roles: Admin, Admissions, Read-only

B. Communication

- Email campaigns (newsletters, reminders, event invites)
- SMS to parents (opt-in / consent tracking)
- Message templates (tour reminder, application deadline, welcome packet)

C. Operations

- Tasks & follow-ups (call back, send packet, schedule tour)
- Calendar (tours, open houses, meetings)
- Basic analytics (inquiries by month, conversion by stage, overdue tasks)

D. Data & Launch

- Import existing contacts / spreadsheet
- School branding (logo, colors, name)
- Admin training session (1 × 60 minutes)
- 30-day post-launch bug-fix window

E. Removed / Hidden (Real Estate–Specific)

- Ringless voicemail, mortgage tools, property finder, Dotloop, RE pipeline labels

Phase 2 (Optional — Quoted Separately)

- Online inquiry & application forms
- Parent portal (view status, upload documents)
- Event registration (open house RSVP)
- Tuition / payment reminders

- Google Classroom / SIS integration
- AI assistant for staff

Out of Scope (Unless Added)

- Full gradebook / attendance / state reporting
- Payroll, accounting, cafeteria
- Native mobile apps (web works on phone)

3. Timeline

Phase	Duration	Deliverable
Discovery & wireframes	Week 1–2	Signed scope, pipeline map, field list
Configuration & UI rebrand	Week 3–5	School-branded CRM shell
Comms + automations	Week 6–7	Email/SMS, templates, workflows
Data import & testing	Week 8	Live workspace with school data
Training & go-live	Week 9	Handoff + documentation
Stabilization	Week 10–12	Bug fixes included in build

Total Phase 1: 10–12 weeks from signed agreement and deposit.

Can compress to ~8 weeks if the school responds quickly on content and decisions.

4. Investment — One-Time Build

Package	Best For	One-Time Fee
Essentials	Small school, admissions CRM only	\$8,500
Standard (Recommended)	CRM + automations + import + training	\$12,500
Plus	Standard + inquiry forms + parent status page	\$18,500

Payment Schedule (Standard):

- 40% at signing — \$5,000
- 40% at beta/demo — \$5,000
- 20% at go-live — \$2,500

5. Monthly Costs

A. Platform & Infrastructure (Pass-Through)

Service	Purpose	Est. Monthly
Hosting (Vercel)	App & API	\$20–\$40
Database (Supabase)	Contacts, activity, settings	\$25–\$75
Authentication (Clerk)	Staff login	\$0–\$25
Email (Resend)	~2,000–5,000 emails/mo	\$0–\$20
SMS (Twilio)	~300–1,000 texts/mo	\$15–\$50
Domain & misc	SSL, monitoring	~\$5
Infrastructure subtotal		\$65–\$215/mo

Typical infrastructure total: \$100–\$250/month depending on SMS volume.

B. Managed Service Fee

Tier	Includes	Monthly
Basic	Monitoring, minor tweaks, email support (48hr)	\$250/mo
Standard (Recommended)	Basic + 2 hrs/mo changes, priority support	\$400/mo
Premium	Standard + quarterly review, template setup	\$650/mo

C. All-In Monthly

	Low	Typical	High
Infrastructure	\$65	\$150	\$250
Management fee	\$250	\$400	\$650
School pays monthly	~\$315	~\$550	~\$900

Positioning: All-in around \$400–\$600/month vs. enterprise software often \$1,000+/month.

6. Updates & New Projects

Type	Examples	Price
Small	Template, tag, pipeline tweak, 1 automation	\$350–\$750
Medium	Form, report, integration, workflow pack	\$1,500–\$3,500
Large	Parent portal, SIS sync, major module	\$5,000–\$15,000+
Hourly	Ad-hoc requests	\$125/hr

7. Competitive Comparison

Option	Typical Cost	Fit
Smiledu / full school ERP	\$200–\$800+/mo	Overkill if CRM-only
SchoolAdmin / Finalsite	~\$1,000+/mo	Strong but expensive for small schools
Generic CRM	\$50–\$800/mo	Flexible, heavy setup
Custom ARI School CRM	~\$12.5K + ~\$400–\$600/mo	Best fit for admissions + comms

8. What We Need from the School

- Inquiries/year and enrolled students
- Current tools in use
- Staff count needing login
- Must-have vs. nice-to-have features
- Sample inquiry → enrollment workflow
- Brand assets
- Data ownership and SMS/email consent policy

9. Risks & Notes

- FERPA / privacy: Phase 1 is staff-facing; parent portal adds compliance review
- SMS requires parent opt-in
- Confirm exact competitor product for pricing comparison
- Full ERP is a separate project or buy off-the-shelf

10. Recommendation

Question	Answer
Does school CRM differ much from ARI?	Core engine: no. Labels, pipeline, fields: yes.
Build all or a portion?	Portion — Phase 1 admissions CRM (~70% reuse)
Build or buy?	Build Phase 1 if CRM + comms is the pain
Competitive monthly?	Yes — target \$400–\$600 all-in

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